郁金香狂热：泡沫与传说

Tulip Mania: The Bubble and the Legend



郁金香真的让整个荷兰破产了吗？

英文原文

In the winter of 1636–37, Dutch **merchants** and **brokers** met in **taverns** to trade **contracts** for **tulip** bulbs still in the ground, a **speculative** business they called windhandel, "trading in the wind". Prices of prized "broken" tulips, with **streaked petals**, **soared**.

In early February 1637, at a sale in Haarlem, the **hub** of the trade, no one would **bid**. Days later, at an **auction** in Alkmaar, one bulb still **fetched** 5,200 guilders, the Dutch **currency** of the day, more than a decade's **wages** for a skilled craftsman. But the **frenzy** was over. Prices **collapsed**, many buyers **defaulted**, and **unsettled** contracts **piled up**. Why the market turned so **swiftly** is still **contested**.

Two centuries later, Charles Mackay, a Scottish **journalist**, **recounted** the **episode** in a book on **popular delusions**, casting it as national **hysteria**. In his telling, rich and poor **gambled**, great merchants were reduced almost to begging, and Dutch **commerce reeled**. His **vivid** account made tulip **mania shorthand for bubbles** fuelled by **reckless** buying.

Yet the **archives** tell a smaller story. Mackay's story **relied** largely **on satirical pamphlets** of 1637 that **preached against greed**. Anne Goldgar, a **historian** at King's College London, **scoured** Dutch records and counted only a few hundred traders, mostly merchants and craftsmen. She found no **bankruptcy** caused by tulips and no **measurable harm** to the **economy**. Many buyers were later allowed to **settle** their contracts by paying **a** small **fraction of** the price, and few were ruined.

The **boom** was real but **fleeting**. What spread, and still **circulates** nearly four centuries on, was the **moral**: a **sermon** drawn from those pamphlets and retold by Mackay as history.

中文译文

1636至1637年的冬天，荷兰的商人和经纪人聚在小酒馆里，买卖尚埋在地下的郁金香球茎的合同。这是一门投机生意，他们称之为windhandel，也就是“风中交易”。名贵的“碎色”郁金香，有着带条纹的花瓣，价格一路飙升/猛涨。

1637年2月初，在交易中心哈勒姆的一场交易会上，无人出价。几天后，在阿尔克马尔的一场拍卖会上，一只球茎仍卖出了5,200荷兰盾——当时荷兰的货币——比一名熟练工匠十多年的工钱还多。但是这场狂热已经结束了。价格暴跌，大量买家违约，未结算的合同越积越多。市场为何转向得如此迅速，至今仍存在争议。

两个世纪后，查尔斯·麦凯，一位苏格兰记者，在一本论述大众错觉/群体性妄想的书中讲述了这一事件，将其描绘为一场全国性的歇斯底里。照他的说法，富人和穷人都在赌博，大商人几乎沦落到去乞讨，荷兰商业仿佛天旋地转。他生动的描述，让郁金香狂热成了泡沫的代名词——而这些泡沫由不计后果的购买所助长。

然而，档案讲述的故事要小得多。麦凯的故事主要依据了1637年的讽刺小册子，这些小册子宣传反对贪婪。伦敦国王学院的历史学家安妮·戈德加彻底搜遍了荷兰的文献记录，然而只数出了几百名交易者，大多是商人和工匠。她没有找到一桩因郁金香而起的破产，也没有发现荷兰经济受到任何可以衡量的损害。许多买家后来获准只付价格的一小部分，就能结清他们的合同，倾家荡产的人也寥寥无几。

这场繁荣确有其事，却转瞬即逝。传播开来、并在近四个世纪后依然流传的，是这个寓意：一篇取材于那些小册子的训诫，被麦凯当作历史重新讲了一遍。

词汇与表达

merchants n.
商人

brokers n.
经纪人
merchants and brokers

taverns n.
小酒馆

contracts n.
合同
contracts for tulip bulbs

tulip n.
郁金香

speculative adj.
投机
a speculative business

streaked adj.
带条纹的

petals n.
花瓣

soared v.
飙升/猛涨
soared

hub n.
中心

bid v.
出价
no one would bid

auction n.
拍卖会

fetched v.
卖出了
one bulb still fetched 5,200 guilders

currency n.
货币

wages n.
工钱

frenzy n.
狂热
the frenzy was over

collapsed v.
暴跌
Prices collapsed

defaulted v.
违约
many buyers defaulted

unsettled adj.
未结算的

piled up phr.
越积越多

swiftly adv.
迅速

contested adj.
存在争议
is still contested

journalist n.
记者

recounted v.
讲述了

episode n.
事件

popular delusions 名词短语
大众错觉/群体性妄想

hysteria n.
歇斯底里
national hysteria

词汇与表达（续）

gambled v.
赌博

commerce n.
商业

reeled v.
天旋地转

vivid adj.
生动的

mania n.
狂热

shorthand for n.
代名词
shorthand for bubbles

bubbles n.
泡沫

reckless adj.
不计后果的
reckless buying

archives n.
档案
the archives tell a smaller story

relied on v.
依据了

satirical adj.
讽刺
satirical pamphlets

pamphlets n.
小册子
satirical pamphlets

preached against v.
宣传反对
pamphlets of 1637 that preached against greed.

greed n.
贪婪

historian n.
历史学家

scoured v.
彻底搜遍了
scoured Dutch records

bankruptcy n.
破产
no bankruptcy caused by tulips

measurable adj.
可以衡量的
no measurable harm to the economy

harm n.
损害

economy n.
经济

a fraction of n.
一小部分

settle v.
结清
settle their contracts

boom n.
繁荣

fleeting adj.
转瞬即逝
real but fleeting

circulates v.
流传

moral n.
寓意

sermon n.
训诫

文章简述

- 热潮：1636至1637年，荷兰商人和经纪人买卖郁金香还在土里的球茎，先签约定以后交货的合同，稀有品种价格暴涨。
- 破裂：1637年2月一场拍卖无人出价，几天后仍有球茎卖到5200荷兰盾，超过工匠十年收入；随后价格崩落，买家违约，许多合约未结清，转折原因仍有争议。
- 传说：约两百年后，记者麦凯把这段经历写成全民投机、商人破产、全国经济受创的故事，主要依据却是当年讽刺贪婪的小册子。
- 档案：历史学家戈德加查阅荷兰记录，只找到数百名交易者，未找到因郁金香而破产或经济遭受可衡量损害的证据。
- 辨别：后来许多买家获准只付原价一小部分就结清合约，鲜有人倾家荡产；价格热潮确有其事，全国性灾难的故事却被夸大了。